



PetRescue Best Friends' Walk 2025 - Media Kit

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Media Release

Australians invited to join PetRescue's Best Friends' Walk 2025

25th August 2025

PetRescue has announced the launch of Best Friends' Walk 2025, a free, month-long event that invites Australians to walk, run, or move to help homeless pets. The event will take place from 1 to 30 September 2025.

People can join the challenge by setting a personal walking goal and creating a fundraising page online. All money raised will help support rescue pets waiting for a new home. The first 1,000 people to sign up will receive a Best Friends' Walk bandana.

PetRescue is a national charity that connects animal rescue groups, shelters, and adopters. Since 2004, it has helped more than 940,000 pets find safe and loving homes across Australia.

"Every step makes a difference," said Patima Tantiprasut, Managing Director of PetRescue. "This walk gives everyone the chance to support rescue groups and help more pets find families."

The 2025 walk will feature online leaderboards and social media challenges where participants can share photos of their pets and walking routes. Pet lovers across the country can take part in their own neighbourhood or preferred locations to show support. People can also sign up solo or form teams with friends and family to walk together for a cause.

Funds raised from Best Friends' Walk 2025 will support PetRescue's programs that help rescue groups, promote pet adoption, and provide better care for animals in need.

Anyone can take part, with or without a pet, by registering at www.bestfriendswalk.com.au.

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About Us



PetRescue is a national animal welfare charity in Australia. It was founded in 2004 by two friends, tech innovator John “JB” Bishop and lifelong animal welfare advocate Vix Davy, who shared a simple dream: to help rescue pets find safe and loving homes. Their vision remains as heartfelt as ever, a future where every pet is safe, respected, and loved, with no healthy, adoptable animal left behind in shelters. Since its early days as Australia’s first national online pet adoption platform, PetRescue has grown into the country’s most successful adoption service, connecting millions of pet lovers with animals in need. It now works with more than 2,000 rescue groups, shelters, veterinary clinics, and local councils nationwide. The charity’s services are designed to make adoption easy and meaningful. Its free, user-friendly platform includes safety checks for adopters and detailed pet profiles to help find the perfect match.



PetRescue also provides crisis care for animals affected by bushfires, floods, and neglect, and runs preventive programs that tackle homelessness before it begins. These include community workshops on responsible pet ownership, affordable desexing clinics that help thousands of pets every year, and pet transport initiatives that move animals from crowded urban shelters to regional communities where more families are ready to adopt, all in partnership with animal transport experts who ensure safe, comfortable journeys. Even with these efforts, animal welfare in Australia still faces some tough challenges. Every month, thousands of healthy pets enter an already stretched system, with many shelters full for months at a time. Veterinary costs keep rising, and the Australian Veterinary Association’s 2024 report highlights that small rescue groups often struggle to afford life-saving treatments. In many remote areas, rescue work depends almost entirely on volunteers and small donations, making essentials like food, bedding, and medical supplies hard to come by.

To help meet these needs, PetRescue hosts the Best Friends' Walk every year, a free, month-long fitness and fundraising challenge that goes beyond a typical charity event. It is more than just a walk; it is a celebration of the bond between people and animals. The event brings communities together, spreads the "adopt, don't shop" message, and reminds everyone that compassion is something we can share through simple action. In recent years, more than 15,000 people from every state and territory, including remote regions like the Northern Territory and Tasmania, have joined in, many as first-time fundraisers. It is a fun, inclusive way to give back and make a difference.

Funds raised through the event go straight into PetRescue's life-saving programs. They support the adoption platform's continued improvement, such as better health profile tools and safety features, and provide rescue groups with essential resources like food, bedding, and medical supplies. Donations also help develop free digital tools created by PetRescue's tech team, like adoption management software that saves rescue volunteers countless hours of admin work. As noted in PetRescue's 2024 annual report, this innovation has been a real game-changer for small and understaffed organisations. The funds also help support remote-area rescue transport, ensuring no pet in an isolated community is forgotten.

What truly makes the Best Friends' Walk special is how it turns everyday moments into real impact. A morning stroll, a weekend hike, or playtime with a foster pet, all of it adds up to meaningful change. For PetRescue, that sense of connection matters just as much as the money raised. It reminds Australians that helping homeless pets does not take expertise or wealth, just a bit of time, compassion, and a willingness to walk together for a cause that matters.



Fact Sheet





Core Information

The Best Friends' Walk 2025 is a free, month-long fitness and fundraising challenge organized by PetRescue, a national animal welfare charity in Australia. The event will take place from 1 to 30 September 2025, inviting Australians of all ages and fitness levels to walk, run, or move in any way they like to raise awareness and funds for homeless pets. Its main goal is to support rescue groups, promote “adopt instead of buy,” and celebrate the human–animal bond.

About PetRescue

Founded in 2004, PetRescue is Australia’s first national online pet adoption platform. It was co-founded by John “JB” Bishop, a tech innovator, and Vix Davy, an animal welfare advocate, who shared a simple idea—helping rescue pets find safe and loving homes.

Over the past two decades, PetRescue has helped more than 940,000 rescue pets find homes and now works with over 2,000 rescue organizations, shelters, veterinarians, and councils across the country.

The organization’s vision is “a future where every pet is safe, respected, and loved.”

PetRescue’s services include a free national adoption platform, crisis care for animals in danger, large-scale food and supply donations, and pet transport projects connecting rescue centers in different regions. It also focuses on early intervention, including community education and low-cost desexing programs to prevent pet homelessness before it starts.

Event Details

The 2025 Best Friends Walk welcomes everyone, pet owners and non-pet owners, to participate individually or in groups with friends, family, or colleagues.

Participants can register for free at www.bestfriendswalk.com.au, set a personal activity goal for September, and choose any activity, such as walking, running, swimming, or playing with their pets.

After registering, participants can create an online fundraising page to share their story and encourage others to donate.

The first 1,000 registrants will receive a limited-edition Best Friends Walk bandana, suitable for both humans and pets.

The event will be flexible in location, allowing participants to participate anywhere—in the community, at a park, at the beach, or in the bush. Features like social media sharing and a real-time fundraising leaderboard will be provided to help keep the community connected.



Fund Usage

All donations raised through Best Friends' Walk go directly toward PetRescue's life-saving work. Funds are used to:

- Maintain and improve the free pet adoption platform with better search tools and safety checks.
- Cover emergency veterinary care for rescued animals suffering from abuse, neglect, or natural disasters.
- Provide essential supplies such as food, bedding, and medical materials to shelters in need.
- Develop digital tools that help rescue organizations reduce administrative work and focus on saving animals.
- Support early intervention programs, including responsible pet ownership education and low-cost desexing clinics.

Key Data

In 2023–2024, 64,554 pets were adopted through PetRescue.

Previous Best Friends' Walk events have drawn over 15,000 participants, with the top individual fundraiser collecting more than AU\$4,000, and the leading team raising over AU\$13,000.

However, challenges remain: every month, thousands of healthy, adoptable pets enter already full shelters, veterinary costs have risen by about 12% in the last two years, and many organizations depend heavily on volunteers due to staffing shortages.





Our People

Patima Tantiprasut

Managing Director, PetRescue

Patima Tantiprasut has served as PetRescue's Managing Director since 2019, leading the national animal welfare charity's strategic growth, program expansion, and cross-sector community engagement. With 20 years of experience in tech and animal welfare leadership, she specializes in charitable project innovation and building resilient rescue networks across the country.

At PetRescue, Patima oversees the free national adoption platform, crisis care for animals affected by disasters or neglect, and flagship events like Best Friends' Walk. Under her leadership, the platform has undergone key digital upgrades and partnered with 2,000+ rescue groups, shelters, and vets—supporting the organization's mission to help hundreds of thousands of pets find safe, loving homes. "Every Australian, regardless of fitness, age, or pet ownership, can make a meaningful difference," Patima says. "Best Friends' Walk turns everyday movement—whether a short neighborhood stroll or a longer hike—into hope for homeless pets, while spreading the critical 'adopt instead of buy' message."





Vix Davy Co-Founder & Strategic Advisor, PetRescue

Vix Davy co-founded PetRescue with JB in 2004 to bridge the gap between rescue pets in need and compassionate adopters. As Strategic Advisor, she focuses on early intervention programs, public education, and upholding the charity's vision: a world where every pet is safe, respected, and loved. With over 20 years of nonprofit and animal rescue experience, Vix grew PetRescue from a small online platform into Australia's top pet adoption service. She designed its signature model—integrating adoption matching, supply donations, and nationwide pet transport—that has helped 940,000+ pets find homes. She also champions low-cost desexing initiatives to address pet homelessness at its source, earning recognition for her impactful contributions to animal welfare.

"We started PetRescue to connect people and pets authentically," Vix reflects. "This walk unites communities through movement and empathy, easing the burden on rescue groups—many operating on tight budgets—and bringing each pet closer to a forever home."

John "JB" Bishop co-founded PetRescue with Vix Davy in 2004 to revolutionize pet adoption through technology, bringing a disruptive, solutions-focused mindset to animal welfare. As Technical Innovation Lead, he oversees the charity's digital platforms, ensuring accessibility and efficiency for rescues and adopters.

With 22 years of technical and leadership experience, JB launched Australia's first national online pet adoption website. Under his stewardship, the platform grew to serve 2,000+ rescue groups, with innovations streamlining pet profiles, adoption checks, and fundraising tools—reducing administrative burdens for rescue teams. He's earned recognition as a 40 Under 40 honoree and a Social Entrepreneur Award for his pioneering work.

"We built PetRescue to connect people and pets through tech," JB says of the 2025 walk. "Simple digital tools turn everyday movement into real change, removing barriers for anyone who loves animals and wants to help."



John "JB" Bishop Co-Founder & Technical Innovation Lead, PetRescue



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